Ruth

Introduction

This account tells us about what happened back in the time when the tribal leaders (misleadingly called 'Judges' in most older English translations) were still ruling Yisrael (Israel), i.e., before their first king. At that time, a long drought caused a famine in Yisrael, which in turned caused Elimelek to move his family to the neighbouring country of Moav. After a time, Elimelek died there in Moav, but eventually their two sons married, and this account focuses on Ruth who was one of those wives. When Ruth's husband also died, she displayed amazing love and dedication towards her mother-in-law, No'omi (whose name means 'pleasant'). When God blessed Yisrael again with good crops, No'omi returned back to her roots in Yisrael and Ruth accompanied her. According to Jewish customs, Ruth needed to marry a relative of her husband, so that Elimelek's name could continue through the generations. Boaz turned out to be that man, and the son they bore became an ancestor of the future King David, and eventually through time, of Yeshua (Jesus) the messiah.

The previous *Accounts of the Heroes and Guides/Leaders* tells about how much the Jewish people suffered because they had turned away from God. So this account reveals how Ruth, a non-Jew, is blessed after she begins to follow Yisrael's god.

Note that the Hebrew name of the main character in this account is 'רוּת' which might be transliterated as 'Rūt' (and pronounced as 'root' with no 'th' at the end). However in weighing up the pros and cons, we have elected to use the traditional spelling of 'Ruth' (rather than 'Rut' which might would be more accurate in one sense, yet would most likely also be pronounced wrongly by most English speakers).

Main components of this account

Ruth accompanies No'omi when she returns home to Beyt-Lehem *1:1-22*
Ruth gets to know Boaz *2:1–3:18*
The marriage of Ruth and Boaz *4:1-22*

Lighter type marks additions. Underscores join parts of a single source word.
Struck words are untranslated. The ◘ sign marks a verse with no text.
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READERS' VERSION

Elimelek goes to Moav during a famine

1:1 Back in the time when the tribal leaders ruled Yisrael (Israel), there was a drought which caused a shortage of food, so a man from the town of Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem) in the Yehudah (Judah) region went to live in the country of Moav (Moab) for a while, taking his wife and their two sons. **2** The man's name was Elimelek and he was married to No'omi (Naomi), and their sons' names were Mahlon and Kilyon. (They were part of the clan of Efratah from Beyt-Lehem in Yehudah.) They travelled to the Moav countryside and lived there. **3** Then No'omi's husband Elimelek died, and she was left with her two sons. **4** Eventually they married women from there in Moav—Orpah and Ruth. But after No'omi and her sons had lived in Moav for about then years, **5** Mahlon and Kilyon both also died, and No'omi was left without her husband or her two sons.

Ruth accompanies No'omi back to Beyt-Lehem

6 One day No'omi (Naomi) was in the countryside there in Moav (Moab) when she heard someone telling about how Yahweh had helped his people in Yisrael (Israel) and that now they had plenty of food, so she got ready to return to Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem) with her two daughters-in-law. **7** The three of them left the place where they'd been living in Moav and started walking along the road back to Yehudah (Judah). **8** Then No'omi said to her two daughters-in-law, "Both of you should go back to your parents' homes. I pray that Yahweh will treat you with the same faithfulness that you showed to your now-deceased husbands and to me. **9** May Yahweh enable both of you to find new husbands and find peace and happiness in your new homes with them."

Then she kissed them as they all wept aloud. **10** But they both said, "No, we'll go with you as you return to your relatives."

11 But No'omi responded, "No, go back to your homes my daughters. Why would you

LITERAL VERSION

1:1 And=he/it_was in÷the_days_of the_judges of_the_judging and=he/it_was a_famine on_the=earth and=he/it_went a_man from÷Bēyt-food/grain/bread Yəhūdāh/(Judah) to÷sojourn in÷the_region(s)_of Mō'āv he and=his/its=woman/wife and÷the_two_of sons_of÷his. **2** And=name_of the=man was_'Elīmelek and=name_of his/its=wife/woman was_No'omī and=name_of the_two_of sons_of÷his was_Maḥlōn and÷Kilion 'Efrātī from÷Bēyt-food/grain/bread Yəhūdāh and=they_came the_region(s)_of Mō'āv and=they_were there. **3** And= 'Elīmelek the_husband_of No'omī =he/it_died and= she and÷the_two_of sons_of÷her =she_was_left. **4** And÷they_took to/for=them wives Mō'āvites the_name_of the=one(f) was_Orpah and=name_of the=second(fs) was_Rūt and=they_lived there about÷ten years. **5** And= also both_of=them Maḥlōn and÷Kilion =they_died and= the=woman =she_was_left from÷both_of children_of÷her and÷from÷husband_of÷her. **6** And= she and÷daughters-in-law_of÷her =she/it_arose and÷she_returned from÷the_region(s)_of Mō'āv if/because she_had_heard in÷the_region_of Mō'āv if/because_that **YHWH** he_had_visited ~~DOM~~ people_of÷his by÷giving to/for=them food. **7** And÷she_went_out from the÷place where she_had_been there÷(to) and÷the_two_of daughters-in-law_of÷her with=her/it and÷they_went on÷way to÷return to the_land_of Yəhūdāh/(Judah). **8** And= No'omī =she/it_said to÷the_two_of daughters-in-law_of÷her go return each_woman to÷the_house_of her_mother_of÷her may_he_deal[1] **YHWH** with÷you(pl) covenant_loyalty just=as you(pl)_have_dealt with the÷dead and÷with÷me. **9** **YHWH** may_he_give to/for=you(pl) and÷find rest each_woman the_house_of her/its=husband/man and÷she_kissed (to)÷them and÷they_raised voice_of÷their and÷they_wept. **10** And÷they_said to÷her if/because with÷you we_will_return to÷people_of÷your. **11** And= No'omī =she/it_said go_back my_daughters_of÷my to/for=what will_you(pl)_go with÷me still to=me do_sons

1 **LV 1:8 · Note** OSHB variant note: השעי: (x-qere) שַׁעֲרִי: lemma=6213 a morph=HVqj3ms id=08nRZ שַׁעֲרִי

READERS' VERSION

bother coming with me? It's not like I could still give birth to more sons to become your husbands. **12** Go on back, my daughters, because I'm too old to remarry. Even if I did hope for that and got married tonight and had some sons, **13** could you wait for them to grow up so you could be remarried? No, my daughters, what's hard for me, even more than your hardships, is that Yahweh is using his power against me."

14 Then they wailed and cried again, and Orpah kissed her mother-in-law goodbye and left, but Ruth stayed and clung to No'omi.
15 No'omi said, "Look, your sister-in-law is going back to her parents and to her religion. Go back with her."

16 But Ruth replied, "Please don't insist that I leave you and go back, because wherever you go, I'll go with you and wherever you live, I'll live there too. Your people are my people, and your god is my god. **17** Wherever you die, I'll die there too and be buried there. May Yahweh punish me severely if anything other than death separates the two of us."

18 When No'omi saw that Ruth was determined to go with her, she didn't say any more.

19 So the two of them travelled on until they reached Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem). When they entered Beyt-Lehem, the whole town was curious about them, and the women began asking, "Is that No'omi?"

20 But No'omi told them not to call her 'No'omi' (which means 'pleasant') but to call her 'Mara' (meaning 'miserable') because she said, "The almighty God has made my life very miserable. **21** I went away content with a family, but Yahweh has brought me back with a void. So why call me 'No'omi'? You see, Yahweh has testified against me—the powerful God has brought misfortune on me."

22 And so No'omi (Naomi) had returned to

Ruth collects grain in Boaz' field

LITERAL VERSION

in÷inward_parts_of÷my and=they_will_be to/for=you(pl) (into)÷husbands. **12** Go_back my_daughters_of÷my go if/because I_am_too_old for÷belonging to÷a_husband if/because I_said there_is to=me hope also I_belonged the=night to÷a_husband and=also I_bore sons. **13** Therefore will_you(pl)_wait until that they_will_grow_up therefore will_you_shut_yourselves_off to=not to_belong to÷a_husband no my_daughters_of÷my if/because it_is_bitter to=me very more÷than_you(pl) if/because it_has_gone_forth on÷me the_hand_of **YHWH**. **14** And÷they_raised voice_of÷their and÷they_wept again and= Orpah =she_kissed (to)÷mother-in-law_of÷her and÷Rūt she_clung to÷her. **15** And=she/it_said THERE sister-in-law_of÷your she_has_returned to people_of÷her and=near/to gods_of÷her go_back after sister-in-law_of÷your. **16** And= Rūt =she/it_said do_not entreat (on)÷me to÷abandon÷you to÷turn_back from÷after÷you if/because to where you_will_go I_will_go and÷at÷where you_will_lodge I_will_lodge people_of÷your people_of÷my and÷god_of÷your god_of÷my. **17** At÷where you_will_die I_will_die and=there I_will_be_buried thus **YHWH** may_he_do to=me and÷thus may_he_add if/because (the)÷death it_will_separate between÷me and÷between÷you. **18** And=she/it_saw if/because_that she was_determined to=go with÷her and÷she_ceased to÷speak to÷her. **19** And= the_two_of÷of_them =they_went until came÷they Bēyt- leḥem and=he/it_was just÷as÷they_came Bēyt- leḥem and= all_of the=city =it_was_stirred on÷them and÷they(f)_said is÷this No῾omī. **20** And=she/it_said to÷them do_not call to=me No῾omī call to=me Mara if/because the_almighty he_has_caused_bitterness to=me exceedingly. **21** I full I_went and÷empty bring_back÷me **YHWH** to/for=what do_you(pl)_call to=me No῾omī and=**YHWH** he_has_testified against÷me and_the÷almighty he_has_done_harm[23] to=me. **22** And= No῾omī =she_returned and÷Rūt the_Mō'āvite÷woman daughter-in-law_of÷her

2 LV 1:21 · Note OSHB note: We read one or more accents in L differently from BHQ.

3 LV 1:21 · Note OSHB note: We read one or more accents in L differently than BHS. Often this notation indicates a typographical error in BHS.

READERS' VERSION

Yisrael (Israel), along with her daughter-in-law, Ruth the Moavit, and they arrived there in Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem) at the start of the barley harvest.

2:1 Now there was a relative there of No'omi's deceased husband. His name was Boaz and he was a very wealthy man from the same clan as Elimelek had been.

2 Ruth the Moavit said to No'omi, "Allow me to go to the countryside and pick up any heads of grain that the harvesters drop.[4] I'll follow any harvester who seems kind."

"Go ahead, my daughter," No'omi replied.

3 So Ruth left and went to the countryside where she picked up heads of grain after the harvesters, and it just so happened that that part of the countryside belonged to Boaz who was Elimelek's relative.

4 Just then, Boaz arrived from the town and greeted the harvesters, "May Yahweh be with you," to which they replied, "May Yahweh bless you also."

5 Then he asked the foreman of the harvesters, "Whose daughter is that young woman over there?"

6 "She's a young Moavit," the man replied. "The one who came with No'omi when she returned from Moav (Moab). **7** She asked me for permission to follow the harvesters and pick up any heads of grain that drop, and she's been doing it since early morning until just recently she's taking a break now in the shelter.

8 So Boaz approached Ruth, "Young woman," he said, "listen here. Don't leave this place or go to any other field to pick up grain, but just stay close by these young female workers of mine. **9** Watch where the men are harvesting and follow along behind them. I've told them

LITERAL VERSION

with=her/it who÷she_returned
from÷the_region(s)_of Mō'āv and÷they they_came
Bēyt- leḥem at_the÷beginning_of the_harvest_of
barley(s).
2:1 And_belonged÷to÷No'ₒmī a_relative[6]
to/for=her/its=man/husband a_man mighty_of
wealth from÷the_clan_of 'Elīmelek
and=his/its=name was_Bo'az. **2** And= Rūt
the_Mō'āvite÷woman =she/it_said to No'ₒmī
let_me_go please the=field so÷that_I_may_glean[7][8][9]
among÷grain[10][11][12] behind the_one_whom
I_will_find favour in÷eyes_of÷his and=she/it_said
to/for=her/it go my_daughter_of÷my.
3 And÷she_went and÷she_came and÷she_gleaned
in_the=field behind the÷harvesters and=
chance_of÷her =it_chanced_on the_portion_of
the=field of÷Bo'az who was_from÷the_clan_of
'Elīmelek. **4** And=BEHOLD/LO/SEE Bo'az
was_coming from÷Bēyt- food/grain/bread
and=he/it_said to÷harvesters **YHWH**
be_with÷you(pl) and=they_said to=him/it
may÷he_bless_you **YHWH**. **5** And= Bo'az
=he/it_said to÷servant_of÷his who÷was_appointed
over the÷harvesters belongs_to÷whom
the_young÷woman (the)÷this. **6** And= the÷servant
who÷was_appointed over the÷harvesters
=he_answered and÷he_said is_a_young_woman
Mō'āvite she who÷she_returned with No'ₒmī
from÷the_region_of Mō'āv. **7** And=she/it_said
let_me_glean please and÷I_will_gather
among÷sheaves behind the÷harvesters
and÷she_came and÷she_has_stayed from÷then
this÷morning and=unto now this sitting÷her
the÷house little. **8** And= Bo'az =he/it_said to Rūt
am=not have_you_heard my_daughter_of÷my
do_not go to÷glean in÷a_field another and=also
not you_must_pass_on from÷this_field and÷thus
you÷will_stay with servants_of÷my_female.

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4 **RV 2:2 · Cross-ref.** Lev 19:9-10; Deu 24:19.

6 **LV 2:1 · Note** OSHB variant note: **עדים**: (x-qere) 'עֲדֹומִ': lemma=4129 morph=HNcmsa id=08swV עֲדֹומִ

7 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.

8 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.

9 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: We read punctuation in L differently from BHS.

10 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.

11 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.

12 **LV 2:2 · Note** OSHB note: We read punctuation in L differently from BHS.

READERS' VERSION

not to bother you. And whenever you're thirsty,
help yourself from the water jars that the men
keep filled."
10 Then she knelt down on the ground and
bowed her head low to the ground and said,
"Why are you being so kind to me when I'm a
foreigner? I wasn't expecting your attention."
11 "People have told me," Boaz replied, "about
everything you've done for your mother-in-law
since your husband died—how you left your
parents and your homeland behind and came
here to live with people that you hadn't even
met before. **12** May Yahweh reward your hard
work. Since you've come here for protection
under Yisrael's (Israel) god Yahweh, may he
reward you in full."
13 "My lord," she replied, "I trust that I'll
continue to please you because you've
comforted me by speaking so kindly to me,
your servant, even though I'm not like your
servant girls."
14 Then when it was time to eat, Boaz told
Ruth, "Come and join us. Take some bread and
dip it in the sauce and eat." So she sat beside
the harvesters, and he also offered her some
roasted grain. She ate until she was full and
even had some left over. **15** Then she went back
to picking up heads and Boaz ordered his men,
"Let her gather grain even among the bundles
and don't shame her. **16** Even pull some stalks
out from the bundles and drop them for her to
pick up, and don't tell her off."
17 So Ruth picked up grain in the countryside
until evening and when she beat the heads and
collected the grains, she had a large basket of
barley. **18** So she picked up the basket and
headed back into town and showed her

LITERAL VERSION

9 Eyes_of÷your in_the=field which
they÷are_harvesting and÷you_will_go[131415]
behind÷them am=not have_I_commanded ~~DOM~~
the_young÷men to=not to÷touch_you
and÷you_will_be_thirsty and÷you_will_go to
the=vessels and÷you_will_drink
some÷of_that_which they÷will_draw
the_young÷men. **10** And÷she_fell on face_of÷her
and÷she_bowed_down ground÷to_the
and=she/it_said to=him/it why have_I_found
favour in÷eyes_of÷your to÷pay÷regard_to_me
and÷I[161718] am_a_foreigner. **11** And= Bo´az
=he_answered and=he/it_said to/for=her/it
fully_(be_told) it_has_been_told to=me all that
you_have_done with mother-in-law_of÷your after
the_death_of your(fs)=man/husband and÷you_left
father_of÷your[192021] and÷mother_of÷your
and÷the_land_of your_kindred_of÷your
and÷you_came to a_people which not you_knew
yesterday three_days_ago. **12** **YHWH**
may_he_reward deed[s]_of÷your and÷may_it_be
wage[s]_of÷your complete from÷with **YHWH**
the_god_of Yisrā'ēl/(Israel) whom you_have_come
to÷take_refuge under wings_of÷his.
13 And=she/it_said I_am_finding favour
in÷eyes_of÷your my=master if/because
you÷have_comforted_me and=because/when
you_have_spoken to the_heart_of
your_maidservant_of÷your and÷I not I_am
like÷one_of your(pl)_maidservants_of÷your.
14 And=he/it_said to÷her Bo´az to÷the_time_of
the_meal approach here and÷you_will_eat some_of
the÷food and÷you_will_dip of_bread_of÷your_piece
in÷vinegar and÷she_sat_down from÷the_side_of
the_harvesters and÷he_held_out to/for=her/it
roasted_grain and=she/it_ate
and÷she_was_satisfied and÷she_had_excess.

13 **LV 2:9 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.
14 **LV 2:9 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.
15 **LV 2:9 · Note** OSHB note: We read one or more vowels in L differently from BHS.
16 **LV 2:10 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.
17 **LV 2:10 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.
18 **LV 2:10 · Note** OSHB note: We read punctuation in L differently from BHS.
19 **LV 2:11 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.
20 **LV 2:11 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.
21 **LV 2:11 · Note** OSHB note: We read punctuation in L differently from BHS.

READERS' VERSION

mother-in-law how much she had collected. Ruth also gave No'omi (Naomi) the roasted grain left-over from her lunch. **19** "Where did you pick up grain today and where did you work?" asked No'omi. "May the man who took notice of you be blessed."

So she told her mother-in-law where she had worked, "The name of the man I worked with today is Boaz."

20 "May he be blessed by Yahweh," responded No'omi. "Yahweh *hasn't* forgotten his kindness towards us who are still living and to our husbands who've died." And then she added, "That man is a close relative of Elimelek. In fact, he's one of those responsible for taking care of our family."[5]

21 "He also told me," said Ruth the Moavit, "to stay with his workers until they finish the harvesting."

22 "It's good, my daughter," said No'omi to her daughter-in-law, "for you to stay near his servant girls because you don't know how people might treat you in another field."

23 So Ruth stayed near Boaz' servant girls and picked up heads of grain until the end of the barley harvest and then the wheat harvest, and she lived with her mother-in-law.

LITERAL VERSION

15 And=she/it_arose to÷glean and= Bo͡az =he/it_commanded ~~DOM~~ servants_of÷his to=say also between the÷sheaves she_will_glean and=not you(pl)÷must_humiliate_her. **16** And=also indeed_(pull_out) you(pl)_will_pull_out to/for=her/it some_of the_bundles÷grain and÷you(pl)_will_leave_them and÷she_will_glean and=not you(pl)_must_rebuke (in)÷her. **17** And÷she_gleaned in_the=field until the÷evening and÷she_beat_out ~~DOM~~ that_which she_had_gleaned and=he/it_was about÷an_'ēyfāh barley(s). **18** And÷she_lifted_it_up and÷she_went the=city and= mother-in-law_of÷her =she/it_saw ~~DOM~~ that_which she_had_gleaned and=she/it_produced and÷she_gave to/for=her/it ~~DOM~~ that_which she_had_left_over from÷abundance_of÷her. **19** And=she/it_said to/for=her/it mother-in-law_of÷her where did_you_glean the=day and÷where did_you_work may_he_be the_one_of÷who_paid_regard_to_you blessed and÷she_told to÷mother-in-law_of÷her ~~DOM~~ whom she_had_worked with=him/it and=she/it_said the_name_of the=man whom I_worked with=him/it the=day is_Bo͡az. **20** And= No͡ʿomī =she/it_said to÷daughter-in-law_of÷her he be_blessed to/for=**YHWH** who not he_has_abandoned loyalty_of÷his_covenant with the÷living and=~~DOM~~ the÷dead and=she/it_said to/for=her/it No͡ʿomī is_near to/for=us the=man is_one÷of÷our_kinsman-redeemers he. **21** And= Rūt the_Mō'āvite÷woman =she/it_said also if/because_that he_said to=me with the÷servants who to=me you÷will_stay until (if) they_have_completed ~~DOM~~ all_of the÷harvest which to=me. **22** And= No͡ʿomī =she/it_said to Rūt daughter-in-law_of÷her is_good my_daughter_of÷my that/for/because/then/when you_will_go_out with servants_of÷his_female and=not people_will_molest (in)÷you in÷a_field another. **23** And÷she_stayed with÷the_female_servants_of Bo͡az to÷glean until the_harvest_of the_barley(s) and÷the_harvest_of the_wheat(s) was_complete and÷she_dwelt with mother-in-law_of÷her.

5 **RV 2:20 · Cross-ref.** Lev 25:25.

READERS' VERSION

Ruth requests Boaz to assume his responsibilities

3:1 One day Ruth's mother-in-law No'omi (Naomi) said to her, "My daughter, I think I need to be finding a secure living situation for you? **2** Now, Boaz whose servant girls you've been working with, he's a relative of ours. In fact, he'll be on the threshing floor winnowing barley tonight. **3** So wash yourself and put on some perfume. Wear your cloak and go out to the threshing floor, but don't let him know you're there until he's finished eating and drinking. **4** Then when he lies down to sleep, pay attention to where he lies down. Once he's asleep, go and lift the blanket near his feet and lie down. Then he'll tell you what to do next."

5 "I'll do everything you say," Ruth answered, **6** then she went out to the threshing floor and did everything her mother-in-law had instructed.

7 When Boaz had finished eating and drinking and was feeling cheery, he went off to lie down at the end of the pile of grain. Then Ruth quietly followed him, and uncovered his feet and lay down there. **8** But Boaz was startled in the middle of the night, and when he turned over he was stunned to find a woman lying at his feet. **9** "Who are you?" he asked.

"I'm your servant Ruth," she replied, "Spread your cloak over me[22] because you have a responsibility as our close relative."

10 "My dear girl, may Yahweh bless you." Boaz replied, "You have shown more kindness now that before,[23] because you haven't chased after the young men, whether rich or poor. **11** So now

LITERAL VERSION

3:1 And=she/it_said to/for=her/it No´ₒmī mother-in-law_of÷her my_daughter_of÷my not will_I_seek to/for=you(fs) a_resting_place that it_will_go_well to/for=you(fs). **2** And=now not is_Bo´az relative_of÷our whom you_were with servants_of÷his_female THERE he will_be_winnowing ~~DOM~~ the_threshing_floor_of the_barley(s) the=night. **3** And÷you_will_wash and÷you_will_anoint_yourself and÷you_will_put mmm[26] on and[27] the_threshing÷floor do_not make_yourself_known to÷man until finishes÷he to÷eat and÷to÷drink. **4** And=let_it_be when÷he÷lies_down and÷you_will_take_note_of ~~DOM~~ the÷place where he_will_lie_down there and÷you_will_go and÷you_will_uncover feet_of÷his and[28] and=he he_will_tell to/for=you(fs) ~~DOM~~ that_which you÷will_do.[29] **5** And=she/it_said to=her/it all that you_are_saying[30] I_will_do. **6** And÷she_went_down the_threshing÷floor and÷she_did according÷to_all that she÷had_commanded_her mother-in-law_of÷her. **7** And= Bo´az =he_ate and÷he_drank and= his/its=heart =it_was_good and÷he_went to÷lie_down at÷the_end_of the_heap and÷she_came in÷secrecy and÷she_uncovered feet_of÷his and÷she_lay_down. **8** And=he/it_was in÷the_middle_of the=night and= the=man =he_trembled and÷he_twisted and=BEHOLD/LO/SEE a_woman was_lying_down feet_of÷his. **9** And=he/it_said who are_you[31] and=she/it_said I am_Rūt your(ms)=female_slave and÷you_will_spread_out skirt_of÷your over maidservant_of÷your if/because are_a_kinsman-redeemer you. **10** And=he/it_said you be_blessed to/for=**YHWH** my_daughter_of÷my

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22 **RV 3:9 · Note** This was the cultural way for Ruth to request Boaz to take her as his wife.

23 **RV 3:10 · Note** Probably referring to Ruth's faithfulness to her mother-in-law.

26 **LV 3:3 · Note** OSHB variant note: תלמש/ך: (x-qere) 'תְּיָתְלֻמְּשׁ': lemma=8071 n=1.0.0 morph=HNcfpc/Sp2fs id=08i9m תְּיָתְלֻמְּשׁ

27 **LV 3:3 · Note** OSHB variant note: יתדרי/ו: (x-qere) 'וְתְּתַרֲרְיִ': lemma=c/3381 morph=HC/Vqq2fs id=08XPV וְתְּתַרֲרְיִ

28 **LV 3:4 · Note** OSHB variant note: יתבכש/ו: (x-qere) 'וְתְּתְבָכְּשִׁ': lemma=c/7901 n=1 morph=HC/Vqq2fs id=08fE2 וְתְּתְבָכְּשִׁ

29 **LV 3:4 · Note** OSHB note: We read one or more vowels in L differently from BHQ.

30 **LV 3:5 · Note** OSHB variant note: (x-qere) 'יְלֵא': lemma=413 n=0.0 morph=HR/Sp1cs id=08k23 יְלֵא

31 **LV 3:9 · Note** OSHB note: We agree with both BHS 1997 and BHQ on an unexpected reading.

READERS' VERSION

dear girl, don't be afraid. I'll do what you've asked for, because the whole town knows that you're an honourable woman. **12** It is true that I have a responsibility towards your family,[24] but there's another man who's more closely related to you all than me. **13** Stay here for the rest of the night, and then in the morning, if he'll accept then he can marry you. But if he's not willing to take care of you, then as Yahweh lives, I'll do it myself. Now lie down here until morning."

14 So Ruth lay there near his feet until morning, but she got up before it was light enough to be recognised as Boaz had said, "It's best if no one knows that a woman visited the threshing floor." **15** Then Boaz said, "Bring your cloak here and hold it out." So she held it while he poured a generous amount of barley into it, and lifted it onto her shoulder. Then he or she[25] went into the town. **16** When Ruth got home, her mother-in-law asked her, "My daughter, how did everything go?"

So Ruth told her everything that Boaz had said and done for her **17** and she also said, "He gave me all this barley because he told me that he didn't want me to return to my mother-in-law empty-handed."

18 "Okay my daughter," No'omi (Naomi) responded. "Wait now until we see what happens, because that man won't rest today until the matter gets settled."

LITERAL VERSION

you_have_made_good loyalty_of÷your (the)÷latter more_than (the)÷former to=not to_go after the_young÷men whether poor and=if rich. **11** And=now my_daughter_of÷my do_not fear all that you_are_saying I_will_do for÷you if/because all_of the_gate_of my_people_of÷my is_knowing if/because_that are_a_woman_of ability you. **12** And=now if/because truly if/because wwww[32] am_a_kinsman-redeemer I and=also there_is a_kinsman-redeemer near more÷than_I. **13** Stay the=night and=it_was in÷morning if he÷will_redeem_you good let_him_redeem and=if not he_will_be_willing to÷redeem÷you and÷I÷will_redeem_you I by_the_life of_**YHWH** lie_down until the÷morning. **14** And÷she_lay_down mmm[3334353637] until the÷morning and=she/it_arose in/on/at/with[38] anyone he_recognized ~~DOM~~ his/its=neighbour and=he/it_said not let_it_be_known if/because_that the=woman she_came the_threshing÷floor. **15** And=he/it_said give the÷shawl which is_on÷you and÷take_hold on÷it and÷she_took_hold on÷it and÷he_measured_out six barley(s) and÷he_put_it on/upon=it(f) and÷he_came the=city. **16** And÷she_came to mother-in-law_of÷her and=she/it_said who are_you my_daughter_of÷my and÷she_told to/for=her/it ~~DOM~~ all that he_had_done to/for=her/it the=man. **17** And=she/it_said the_six the÷barley(s) the=these he_gave to=me if/because he_said[39] do_not go empty to mother-in-law_of÷your. **18** And=she/it_said

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24 **RV 3:12 · Cross-ref.** Ruth 2:20.

25 **RV 3:15 · Note** TC: There's no separate Hebrew word for 'he' or 'she' here—it's part of the verb 'he/she_went' but it's unclear if this original verb was marked *masculine* or *feminine*, hence you'll find both alternatives in various Bible translations.

32 **LV 3:12 · Note** OSHB variant note: **אּם**: (x-qere)

33 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB variant note: **ו/תלגרמ**: (x-qere) 'וְ/יִתּוֹלְגְּרַמ': lemma=4772 n=1.2.0 morph=HNcfpc/Sp3ms id=08EAT וְ/יִתּוֹלְגְּרַמ

34 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB note: Marks a place where we agree with BHQ against BHS in reading L.

35 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB note: We read one or more consonants in L differently from BHS.

36 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB note: Marks an anomalous form.

37 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB note: We read one or more vowels in L differently from BHS.

38 **LV 3:14 · Note** OSHB variant note: **בּ/סורט**: (x-qere) 'בְּ/סָרֶט': lemma=b/2962 n=1.0.0 morph=HR/D id=08vSy בְּ/סָרֶט

39 **LV 3:17 · Note** OSHB variant note: (x-qere) 'אַל/י': lemma=413 n=0.1 morph=HR/Sp1cs id=086C3 אַל/י

READERS' VERSION

Boaz takes over the land and gets Ruth as a wife

4:1 Meanwhile, Boaz went to the place inside the town gate (where people conducted their official business) and sat down there. Just as he had hoped, the man responsible for No'omi's (Naomi) family came along—the man whom Boaz had mentioned earlier—and Boaz called out to him by name and said, "Come over here and sit down." So the man came over and sat down. **2** Then Boaz called over ten of the older, well-respected men from the town and asked them to sit and witness their discussion, so they sat down with them. **3** Then Boaz asked the other relative, "The part of the countryside that belonged to our relative Elimelek is for sale. No'omi, who recently returned from Moav (Moab), is selling it. **4** I thought that I should tell you about it and in case you buy the land while the people sitting here are listening, including these leaders of our people. If you want to buy it back into the family, then do so. But if you do not want to buy it back, then let me know, because you are the closest relative to Elimelek, and I am next after you."

"I'll buy it," the man replied.

5 "When you buy the land from No'omi," Boaz continued, "you will also need to marry Ruth, our deceased relative's widow from Moav, so that she'll have a son who will inherit the property and continue Elimelek's family line."

6 "I can't buy it back myself, then," the closer relative answered. "If I did that, I would ruin my own son's inheritance. You can have the land and the woman instead of me, because I simply can't take it."

7 (At that time in Yisrael (Israel), people had a

LITERAL VERSION

sit_down my_daughter_of÷my until that you÷will_know how a_matter will_it_fall_out if/because not the=man he_will_be_at_peace if/because (if) he_has_finished the÷matter the=day.

4:1 And÷Bo͗az he_went_up the÷gate and=he/it_sat_down//remained//lived there and=BEHOLD/LO/SEE the÷kinsman-redeemer was_passing_by whom Bo͗az he_had_spoken and=he/it_said turn÷aside sit here a_certain_one a_certain_one and÷he_turned_aside and÷he_sat_down. **2** And=he/it_took ten men of÷the_elders_of the=city and=he/it_said sit here and÷they_sat_down. **3** And=he/it_said to÷redeemer the_portion_of the=field which belonged_to÷brother_of÷our to÷'Elīmelek No͗ₒmī who÷she_returned from÷the_region_of Mō'āv she_has_sold. **4** And÷I I_said I_will_uncover ear_of÷your to=say acquire_it before those÷sitting and÷before the_elders_of my_people_of÷my if you_will_redeem redeem and=if not he_will_redeem tell to/for=me and[44] if/because there_is_not except÷you to÷redeem and÷I am_after÷you and=he/it_said I I_will_redeem. **5** And= Bo͗az =he/it_said in/on=day acquire÷you the=field from÷the_hand_of No͗ₒmī and÷from÷with Rūt the_Mō'āvite÷woman the_wife_of the_dead_man you_have_acquired[45] to÷raise_up the_name_of the_dead_man over inheritance_of÷his. **6** And= the÷kinsman-redeemer =he/it_said not I_am_able mmm[46] to=me lest I_should_ruin ~~DOM~~ inheritance_of÷my_own redeem to/for=yourself(m) you ~~DOM~~ of_redemption_of÷my_right if/because not I_am_able to÷redeem_it. **7** And÷this formerly÷former_times was_in÷Yisrā'ēl/(Israel) on the÷redemption and÷on the÷exchanging to÷confirm every_of matter anyone he_drew_off sandal_of÷his and=he/it_gave to÷neighbour_of÷his and÷this was_the÷attestation in÷Yisrā'ēl/(Israel). **8** And= the÷kinsman-redeemer =he/it_said to÷Bo͗az acquire_it to/for=you(fs)

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44 LV 4:4 · Note OSHB variant note: עדא/ו: (x-qere) הָעֵדֶא/וֹ: lemma=c/3045 n=1.1.1 morph=HC/Vqh1cs id=08fbk הָעֵדֶא/וֹ

45 LV 4:5 · Note OSHB variant note: יתינק: (x-qere) הָתִּנָּק: lemma=7069 n=0.1 morph=HVqp2ms id=08cqw הָתִּנָּק

46 LV 4:6 · Note OSHB variant note: לואנ/ל: (x-qere) לְאָנְ/ל: lemma=l/1350 a morph=HR/Vqc id=08Ynf לְאָנְ/ל

READERS' VERSION

different way of buying land or exchanging goods between them. In order to make these matters legally binding, one man would take off one of his sandals and give it to the other party.[40] That was the way people in Yisrael confirmed what they had agreed to do.)

8 "You buy it yourself," the relative said and he took off one of his sandals and gave it to Boaz. **9** Then Boaz said to the respected men and to all the other people who were there, "Today you have all witnessed that I've bought from No'omi all the property that belonged to Elimelek, Kilyon, and Mahlon. **10** I am also taking Ruth, Mahlon's widow from Moav, to be my wife so that she can have a son. Everyone will consider that son to be Elimelek's descendant and he will inherit the property and carry on Elimelek's family name among his relatives and here in his hometown.[41] You've seen and heard that today and can tell anyone who asks about it."

11 All the respected men, and the others who were sitting at the town gate, agreed, and they said, "Yes, we are your. We pray that Yahweh will allow this woman who will be coming into your home, to be like Rahel (Rachel) and Le'ah, the two who gave birth to our ancestors and started our people, Yisrael.[42] May you become great in the clan of Efratah and famous here in Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem)! **12** We pray that your family will be like the family of your ancestor Perets, son of Yehudah (Judah) and Tamar,[43] because of the many descendants that Yahweh will give to you and this young woman."

Boaz' descendants

13 So Boaz married Ruth, and when he slept with her, Yahweh enabled her to become pregnant and she gave birth to a son. **14** The women in Beyt-Lehem (Bethlehem) said to No'omi (Naomi), "Praise Yahweh for giving you a male descendant to preserve your family today. We pray to Yahweh that people throughout Yisrael (Israel) will

LITERAL VERSION

and÷he_drew_off sandal_of÷his. **9** And= Bo'az =he/it_said to÷elders and=all the÷people are_witnesses you(pl) the=day if/because_that I_acquire ÐOM all_of that belonged_to÷'Elīmelek and=ÐOM all_of that belonged_to÷Kilion and÷Maḥlōn from÷the_hand_of No'ₒmī. **10** And=also ÐOM Rūt the_Mō'āv̄ite÷woman the_wife_of Maḥlōn I_acquire to=me to/for=(a)_woman to÷raise_up the_name_of the_dead_man over inheritance_of÷his and=not the_name_of the_dead_man it_will_be_cut_off from÷with brothers_of÷his and÷from÷the_gate_of his_place_of÷his are_witnesses you(pl) the=day. **11** And= all_of the÷people which was_at÷gate and÷the÷elders =they_said we_are_witnesses **YHWH** may_he_make ÐOM the=woman who÷is_about_to_come into house_of÷your like÷Rāḥēl and÷like÷Lē'āh who the_two_of÷of_them they_built ÐOM the_house_of Yisrā'ēl/(Israel) and÷make wealth in÷'Efrātāh and÷proclaim a_name in=house_of leḥem. **12** And=let_it_be household_of÷your like÷the_household_of Perets whom Tāmār she_bore to÷Yəhūdāh/(Judah) from the÷offspring which **YHWH** he_will_give to/for=yourself(m) from the_young÷woman (the)÷this.

13 And= Bo'az =he/it_took ÐOM Rūt and=it_became to=him/it to/for=(a)_woman and÷he_went to=her/it and= **YHWH** =he/it_gave to/for=her/it conception and=she/it_gave_birth a_son. **14** And= the÷women =they_said to No'ₒmī **YHWH** who not he_has_caused_to_cease to/for=you(fs) a_kinsman-redeemer the=day be_blessed and= his/its=name =may_it_be_proclaimed

40 **RV 4:7-8 · Cross-ref.** Deu 25:9.

41 **RV 4:10 · Cross-ref.** Deu 25:5-6.

42 **RV 4:11 · Cross-ref.** Gen 29:31.

43 **RV 4:12 · Cross-ref.** Gen 38:27-30.

READERS' VERSION

greatly respect him. **15** Your daughter-in-law,
who loves you and who's been better to you
than if you had seven sons, has given birth to
him. Now he'll make you feel young again and
he'll take care of you when you get old."
16 Then No'omi picked up the baby and held
him closely and became like second mother to
him.

17 The women who were living nearby said,
"It is as if No'omi now has a son!" They named
him Oved.

Eventually Oved went on to become the
father of Yishay (Jesse), who became the father
of King David.[47] **18** Here is a list of the
descendants of Perets: Perets's son was
Hetsron. **19** Hetsron's son was Ram and Ram's
son was Aminadav. **20** Aminadav's son was
Nahshon and Nahshon's son was Salmon.
21 Salmon's son was Boaz and Boaz's son was
Oved. **22** Oved's son was Yishay and Yishay's son
was King David.

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LITERAL VERSION

in÷Yisrā'ēl/(Israel). **15** And=it_was to/for=you(fs)
(into)_one÷who_restores life and÷to÷sustain ~~ĐOM~~
age_of÷your_old if/because
daughter-in-law_of÷your who she÷loves_you
she÷has_given_birth_to_him who she is_good
to/for=you(fs) more÷than_seven sons. **16** And=
No'omī =she/it_took ~~ĐOM~~ the÷child
and÷she÷placed_him on÷bosom_of÷her
and=it_became to=him/it (into)_a÷nurse.
17 And÷they_called to=him/it
the_female÷neighbours a_name to=say a_son
he_has_been_born to÷No'omī and÷they_called
his/its=name 'Ōvēd he was_the_father_of
Yishay/(Jesse) the_father_of Dāvid. **18** And=these
are_the_descendants_of Perets Perets he_fathered
~~ĐOM~~ Ḥetsrōn. **19** And÷Ḥetsrōn he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~
Rām and÷Rām he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ 'Amminādāv.
20 And÷'Amminādāv he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ Naḥshōn
and÷Naḥshōn he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ Salmah.
21 And÷Salmōn he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ Bo'az and÷Bo'az
he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ 'Ōvēd. **22** And÷'Ōvēd he_fathered
~~ĐOM~~ Yishay and÷Yishay he_fathered ~~ĐOM~~ Dāvid.

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47 **RV 4:17 · Cross-ref.** Mat 1:5-6.